9.01 Meaning and Definition of Human Resource

With the advent of globalisation, liberalisation and privatisation leading to advancement in information, communication and technology paved way for exhibiting the high level of innovation and creativity in human resource. In the current scenario unless the organisation recruits, selects and utilises high quality human resource the sustainability remains a question. In order to accomplish personal and organisational objectives the unique asset called human resource has to be appropriately placed and appreciated. In an organisation the human resource are the employees who are inevitable for the survival and success of the enterprise.

According to Peter.F.Drucker "Man, of all resources available to him, can grow and develop"

It is clear from the definitions that not all human beings are considered to be human resources but only those individuals who acquired the required skill sets, talents, knowledge, competencies and capabilities in the accomplishment of both individual and organisational objectives.

9.02 Characteristics of Human Resources

The unique, peculiar and distinctive features of human resources are as under:

i. Human resource is the only factor of production that lives
ii. Human resource created all other resources
iii. It is only the labour of employees that is hired and not the employee himself
iv. Human resource exhibits innovation and creativity
v. Human resource alone can think, act, analyse and interpret
vi. Human resources are emotional beings
vii. Human resources can be motivated either financially or non financially
viii. The behaviour of human resources are unpredictable
ix. Over years human resources gains value and appreciates
x. Human resources are movable
xi. Human resource can work as a team

9.03 Significance of Human Resources

The vital resource namely human resource is significant because of the following reasons :

i. It is only through human resource all other resources are effectively used
ii. The sustainable growth of an organisation depends on the important resource human resource
iii. Industrial relations depend on human resource
iv. Human relations is possible only through human resource
v. Human resource manages all other factors of production
vi. The skill sets of the Human resources can be improved through training and development programmes
vii. Human resource can be utilised at all levels of management
viii. Human resources are well protected by legislative frameworks.

9.04 Meaning and Definition of Human Resource Management

The branch of management that deals with managing human resource is known as Human Resource Management. In order to achieve the personal and organisational objectives human resources are to be trainedup and managed. In short, it is managing people of different strata for the accomplishment of the organisational goals. It includes the overall progress of the employee and the enterprise.

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